



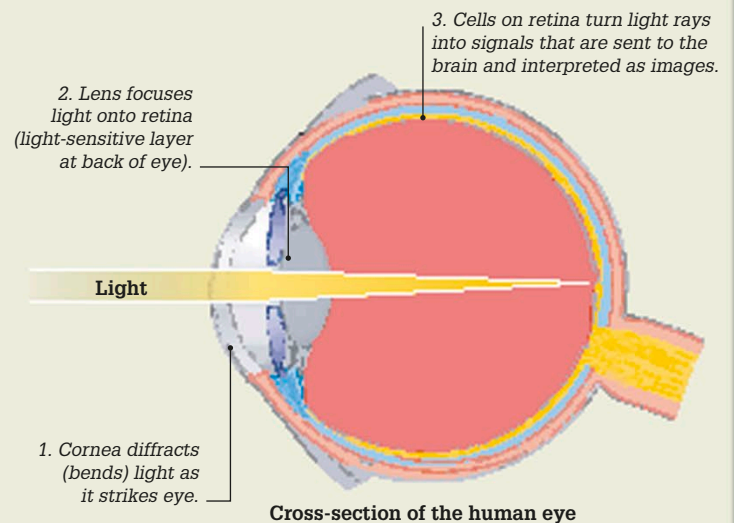
1300

Rainbow theory

German monk Theodoric of Freiburg used small, water-filled glass bottles to show that light passing through them was both reflected and refracted (sent in different directions). He concluded that beams of sunlight hitting water drops in a cloud bend in the same way, causing a rainbow.

LENSES AND THE EYE

The Ancient Greeks believed that vision was the result of the eye emitting a wave that bounced back from an object in the line of sight. By the 13th century, scholars such as Roger Bacon (see pp.48–49) understood it was the other way around: that light emitted from an object hit the lens of the eye to create an image.



1305

1315

First public dissection

Italian physician Mondino da Luzzi performed the first public dissection of a body at Bologna, Italy. This gave medical students and doctors a greatly improved understanding of human anatomy.

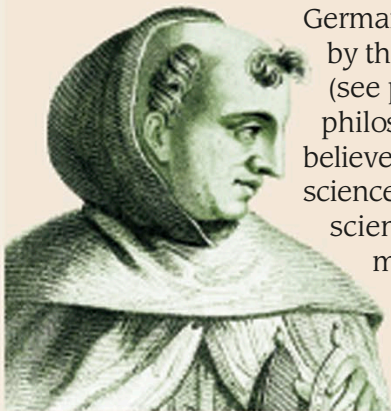
1323

Ockham's razor

In his book *Summa Logicae* (The Sum of Logic), English friar William of Ockham reasoned that seeking an explanation for something should be simplified by cutting out any unnecessary information or arguments. The principle became known as Ockham's razor.

1345

c 1200–1280 ALBERTUS MAGNUS



German Dominican friar Albertus Magnus was inspired by the work of the Ancient Greek philosopher Aristotle (see pp.30–31) to compile an encyclopedia of philosophical and scientific knowledge. Albertus believed in discovering the causes of things through science, and he is regarded as the founder of natural science as a field of study. His work ranged across many subjects, including theology (study of religion), logic, zoology, and alchemy (medieval chemistry). He was an excellent teacher and among his pupils was the famous Christian theologian Thomas Aquinas.



Page from Magnus's treatise on natural history